
DIH HYBRID CHAIN LIBRARY

Vocal, drums, bass, and instrument routing recipes

Hybrid routing, not generic stacking.

Every recipe combines a controlled source lane with a parallel or aux lane, plus detector-only sidechain control only where it solves a real masking problem.

Operating law

- SILVER is the neutral M50 reference mic: gain-match it to the dry source before judging tone or level.
- GOLD is the color mic: compare it against SILVER at equal loudness and retain it only for deliberate harmonic body, presence, soul, weight, or dimensional lift.
- Do not make a serial GOLD-to-SILVER chain the default; Silver is the baseline and Gold is an optional color choice.
- Gain-stage first. Start bus auditioning around -18 dBFS and make every decision at matched loudness.
- Keep a source or bus lane to three active processors maximum. Aux returns are distinct lanes.
- A sidechain is detector control only: it must never become audible in the destination.
- Keep a stage only if it improves the arrangement, not only a soloed source.
- Check mono whenever EchoLocate, Depth Boost Pro, PARALLAX, or NSR is active.

Research basis

The recipes translate current recurring engineering practice to the documented DIH processors: controlled source tone, dynamics and sibilance management, deliberate character, and separate time/space or parallel-impact lanes. They are production starting points, not universal presets.

iZotope - Crafting a basic vocal chain: <https://www.izotope.com/en/learn/crafting-a-basic-vocal-chain>

MusicRadar - vocal-chain design: <https://www.musicradar.com/how-to/vocal-chain>

MusicRadar - modern drum processing: <https://www.musicradar.com/music-tech/drum-processing-techniques-drum-week>

MusicRadar - 808/kick and bass separation: <https://www.musicradar.com/tutorials/the-tr-808s-bass-drum-is-undoubtedly-the-most-recognisable-electronic-kick-sound-of-all-time-how-to-get-the-perfect-808s>

Vocal hybrids

Keep the dry lead authoritative; generate size, harmony, delay, and reverb on controlled returns.

V-01 PRESENT LEAD / CONTROLLED INTIMACY

Use when: The lead needs to stay upfront without becoming sharp or flat.

Reference check: SILVER -> level-matched comparison
Color option: GOLD -> AEGIS NOVA -> OTIS -> Lead Vocal Bus
Lead Vocal Bus send -> Cathedral -> ANUBIS (lead keyed, Duck on) -> return

- SILVER is the neutral M50 reference: establish the honest vocal baseline before changing character.
- GOLD is the color option: add restrained Body, Presence, and Focus only when the arrangement benefits from it.
- AEGIS NOVA controls plosives and sibilance before dynamics react; OTIS catches micro peaks with only enough Meso Density to stabilize phrases.
- The Cathedral return is ducked by the dry lead so tail blooms between words.

Success test: The lyric remains fixed in front while consonants and reverb do not jump forward; the Gold color remains a deliberate, level-matched choice.

V-02 RAP FRONT / DRY AUTHORITY

Use when: The vocal has to carry rhythm and articulation with almost no audible wash.

Lead vocal: SILVER -> AEGIS NOVA -> DEBO -> Lead Vocal Bus
Lead Vocal Bus send -> NTRSTLLR -> ANUBIS (lead keyed, Duck on) -> throw return

- SILVER: use Truth and Precision for intelligibility; add Air only after sibilance is controlled.
- Begin DEBO from VOCAL HOLD [Stereo], then bypass-match before adding Maximize.
- Use NTRSTLLR only as an automated phrase-end throw, not a permanent audible delay.

Success test: Every word reads at low level; delay appears only at chosen phrase endings.

V-03 HALO 2 / WIDE VOCAL ATMOSPHERE

Use when: A cinematic halo is wanted without losing a dry, stable center.

Dry lead: WPR -> AEGIS NOVA -> OTIS -> Lead Vocal Bus
Halo 2 aux: TRIPLER -> EchoLocate -> SacredVerb -> ANUBIS (lead keyed, Duck on)

- WPR sets a controlled ribbon/proximity character on the dry lead.
- TRIPLER intervals must follow the song key and scale; start support voices lower than the center.
- EchoLocate and SacredVerb live only on the aux so the lead remains controllable.
- Duck the return from the dry lead; use pre-delay to separate voice and halo.

Success test: The lead works when the aux is muted; the aux adds width without weakening the center.

Drum hybrids

Separate transient intent, bus cohesion, and environment so the groove stays intact.

D-01 MODERN PROGRAMMED KIT / PUNCH WITH A STABLE BUS

Use when: A programmed kit needs movement and impact in a dense arrangement.

Instrument track: DIH Drum Morpher -> BALLPARK -> DrumKrushGlue -> Drum Bus
Kick pad/send -> MARIANA or MONOLITH sidechain input on bass lane

- Start Drum Morpher in HYBRID for kick, snare, and tom body; leave hats nearer SAMPLE.
- Start Layer around 15-30% and Variation around 5-15%.
- Use Ballpark for impact/placement before DrumKrushGlue cohesion.
- Send only a kick guide to the bass key path. It moves the documented added low-end layer, not the dry bass.

Success test: The bus adds authority without making the kick smaller or flatter.

D-02 PARALLEL DRUM IMPACT / TRANSIENT BODY SPLIT

Use when: The main drum bus is balanced but needs optional weight and aggression.

Main drum bus: LOOKOUT -> KHEPRI -> APIS -> Drum Master
Parallel Impact aux: DrumKrushGlue -> return blended under main bus

- LOOKOUT selects envelope first: add Attack for snap or Sustain for body, never both aggressively.
- KHEPRI Drum Punch is the first tape starting point; reduce Drive first if cymbals become grainy.
- Blend the DrumKrushGlue return under the dry bus until it becomes felt rather than separately obvious.

Success test: Kick and snare are easier to follow at low volume, with no brittle hat edge.

D-03 DRUM ATMOSPHERE THAT GETS OUT OF THE WAY

Use when: Percussion needs a larger environment without blurring every transient.

Dry drum bus -> output
Post-fader send -> NTRSTLLR -> Cathedral -> ANUBIS (kick or drum bus keyed, Duck on) -> Drum Space return

- NTRSTLLR supplies timed movement; Cathedral adds density after it.
- Key ANUBIS from kick or dry drums so the return yields during hits and fills the gaps.
- If low-end wash develops, restrain the return in the host before adding more processors.

Success test: Muting the return makes the track smaller, not cleaner.

Bass hybrids

Keep the true foundation central and use harmonic/color layers for translation and controlled movement.

B-01 808 TRANSLATION / KICK-POCKET LOW END

Use when: An 808 needs readable pitch and weight while a separate kick keeps its first impact.

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808 source: NTRPL -> MARIANA -> MONOLITH -> Bass Bus  
Kick send -> MARIANA KEY and/or MONOLITH KEY
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- Use NTRPL at low Mix to create upper harmonic readability while Originality Guard preserves the fundamental.
- MARIANA KICK DUCK FOUNDATION is the firm-pocket start; GENTLE KEY BREATH is subtler.
- Enable MONOLITH key only if its added stone/weight layer still crowds the kick.

Success test: The bass note translates on small speakers while the kick transient leads on full-range monitoring.

B-02 LIVE BASS / WARM STABILITY

Use when: An electric or picked bass needs continuity and body without obvious pumping.

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Bass source: KHEPRI -> MARIANA -> MONOLITH -> Bass Bus
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- Begin KHEPRI from Bass Foundation with Gain Match enabled.
- Use MARIANA Depth/Foundation only until held notes stop falling away; keep key off unless there is a real kick conflict.
- Use MONOLITH Weight and Resonance modestly; sustained resonance should not grow louder instead of clearer.

Success test: Held notes are even, attacks retain identity, and the lowest foundation stays mono-secure.

B-03 WIDE BASS COLOR / PROTECTED MONO FOUNDATION

Use when: Upper bass character needs width while true foundation remains central.

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Main bass: MARIANA -> MONOLITH -> Bass Bus  
Upper-color aux: band-limited bass send -> Depth Boost Pro -> PARALLAX -> return
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- Keep MARIANA and MONOLITH as the centered, authoritative lane.
- Feed the aux only upper bass character, not the deepest sub.
- Use Spatial Gain in Depth Boost Pro to avoid loudness bias and reduce the aux first if mono weakens.

Success test: Stereo feels larger, while mono retains pitch, punch, and sub weight.

Instrument hybrids

Build source identity, then create space around the vocal or rhythm rather than across it.

I-01 MUSIC-BED POCKET / VOCAL-AWARE INSTRUMENTS

Use when: Keys, guitars, samples, or a full music bus compete with the lead vocal.

Source track(s): KHEPRI -> PTAHTUBE -> APIS -> Music Bus
Music Bus: TEHUTI (lead vocal keyed) -> output

- Use tape, tube, and body/air as separate decisions; omit a stage if it adds no value.
- TEHUTI begins with Mid Duck. Add a little High Duck only if vocal consonants or air are masked.
- Avoid Low Duck unless low-mid buildup is genuinely competing with the voice.

Success test: The music is full in vocal pauses and only moves in the vocal intelligibility range when the singer enters.

I-02 PAD BREATHING / CINEMATIC SUPPORT

Use when: Pads need depth but must pulse around the vocal instead of covering it.

Pad source: AU -> THOTH -> TEHUTI (lead vocal keyed) -> Pad Bus
Pad Bus send -> PARALLAX -> NSR -> Pad Depth return

- Establish the AU envelope before harmonic or spatial processing.
- Use THOTH shelves as broad tonal decisions, not surgical correction.
- Set TEHUTI depth/speed for natural breathing. Put width/motion on the return and monitor NSR correlation.

Success test: Vocal lines stay intelligible while held chords deepen between phrases.

I-03 ARTICULATE GUITAR OR PIANO / FOCUSED COLOR

Use when: A live harmonic instrument needs to speak through a busy arrangement without heavy compression.

Instrument source: THOTH -> KHEPRI -> LOOKOUT -> Instrument Bus

- Choose the broad THOTH low/high relationship first.
- KHEPRI Clean Print is the transparent start; Air Repro is the open-top alternative.
- Use LOOKOUT Attack for pick/hammer definition or Sustain reduction for room/pedal wash.

Success test: Articulation becomes clearer at the same fader position, not merely brighter or louder.

I-04 CREATIVE SYNTH HOOK / MOVEMENT WITH A CLEAN ANCHOR

Use when: A hook needs a moving signature but must retain original pitch and timing.

Instrument source: AU -> NTRPL -> THOTH -> Hook Bus
Kick or rhythm guide -> NTRPL KEY (optional, rewrite layer only)

- Finalize AU envelope first, then begin NTRPL from SOURCE TRACE.
- Raise Novelty, Chord Rewrite, and Interval Distance gradually; use Mix to preserve the original center.
- Use the optional key only when the generated layer crowds the rhythm. The source remains audible.

Success test: The hook is identifiable dry and unmistakable, but still musical, with rewrite blended in.

Fast decision map

Problem	First DIH move	Hybrid extension
Vocal too exposed	AEGIS NOVA before dynamics	Duck a Cathedral/NTRSTLLR return with ANUBIS
Vocal lacks size	Set SILVER baseline; compare optional GOLD color at equal loudness	Use Halo 2: TRIPLER -> EchoLocate -> SacredVerb
Drums lack punch	LOOKOUT or BALLPARK on dry path	Blend DrumKrushGlue on a parallel impact lane
Kick and bass collide	MARIANA or MONOLITH key on bass layer	Preserve dry bass; move only added weight layer
Bass is felt but not heard	Low-Mix NTRPL before bass processors	Add upper-only Depth Boost Pro/PARALLAX aux
Instruments hide lyric	TEHUTI keyed from vocal on music bus	Place width/motion on a return, not dry source

Before saving a chain

- Bypass-match every active insert and aux return.
- Confirm the sidechain source is not audible in the target destination.
- Test the entire arrangement, then test mono compatibility.
- Name saved presets by source, function, tempo/key context, and sidechain source - never a vague adjective alone.